PROJECT PROPOSAL DOCUMENT

THE STATE UNIVERSITY OF ZANZIBAR (SUZA)

DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER SCIENCE AND INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

SN	STUDENTS NAME	REGISTRATION NUMBER
1	KHADIJA ALI SAID	24BCS026
2	RAHMA SULEIMAN ABDALLA	24BIT038

PROJECT TITLE

University Innovation Connect (UIC): A Collaborative Web Platform for Connecting SUZA Students with Real Community Challenges in Zanzibar

PROJECT TYPE

Web-Based Software Development (Prototype)

TARGET BENEFICIARIES

- SUZA Students
- Lecturers
- Student Innovators
- SUZA Innovation Stakeholders

BACKGROUND AND MOTIVATION

Zanzibar faces various development challenges in sectors such as Blue Economy, Agriculture, Health, Fintech, and Social Services. At the same time, SUZA students have innovative ideas and technical skills but lack a structured platform to connect their ideas with real community problems.

Currently, ideas are mostly shared through informal platforms such as WhatsApp groups and social media. These platforms do not support proper documentation, evaluation, or structured collaboration. As a result, many ideas are lost, duplicated, or never developed into real solutions.

This project proposes a structured digital platform that connects students and lecturers in order to promote innovation, collaboration, and problem-solving within the university environment.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

There is no centralized system at SUZA for collecting, managing, and evaluating innovative ideas and linking them with academic and community needs.

This leads to:

- Loss of innovative ideas
- Lack of structured collaboration among students
- Repetition of similar projects
- Weak connection between academic work and real-world challenges

Therefore, a web-based system is required to solve this problem.

PROJECT DESCRIPTION AND SCOPE

University Innovation Connect (UIC) is a web-based platform designed to enable students and lecturers to share, discuss, and improve innovative ideas within the university environment.

The system will allow users to:

- Register and log in
- Post ideas and challenges
- View ideas from other users
- Comment on ideas
- Vote for best ideas
- Lecturers provide feedback on submitted ideas

Scope of the Project

University Innovation Connect (UIC) is a web-based system that enables students, lecturers, and student innovators to collaborate in solving and sharing innovative ideas within the university environment. Due to time limitations , the system will focus only on core features:

- User authentication (Registration & Login)
- Idea and challenge posting
- Commenting system
- Simple voting system
- Lecturer feedback system

Future Enhancements:

- Team formation module
- Knowledge repository
- Community external integration

FEASIBILITY STUDY

Technical Feasibility

The system is technically feasible using the following technologies:

- Frontend: React.js
- Backend: Spring Boot
- Database: PostgreSQL
- Tools: VS Code, Postman, GitHub

These tools are free, widely used, and suitable for student development.

Operational Feasibility

- The system is simple and user-friendly
- Students and lecturers can easily adopt it
- It improves communication and innovation sharing
- Supports collaboration within SUZA academic environment

Economic Feasibility

- The project uses free and open-source technologies
- No licensing costs required
- Development uses available student resources
- Minimal budget is needed

Schedule Feasibility

Project duration: **5 Weeks**

AIM AND OBJECTIVES

Main Objective

To develop a web-based platform that enables SUZA students and lecturers to share, discuss, and improve innovative ideas.

9.2 Specific Objectives

- To design a user authentication system
- To implement idea posting and sharing features
- To develop a commenting and feedback system
- To implement a simple voting system

PROJECT METHODOLOGY (AGILE MODEL)

This project will follow the **Agile Software Development Methodology**, which emphasizes iterative development, continuous feedback, and incremental delivery.

Agile Approach Description

The system will be developed in small iterations (sprints). Each sprint delivers a functional part of the system.

- Continuous improvement based on feedback
- Frequent testing during development
- Collaboration between team members and supervisor

Sprint Plan (5 Weeks)

Sprint 1 (Week 1): Planning & Requirements

- Requirement gathering
- System analysis
- Initial design

Sprint 2 (Week 2): System Design

- UI/UX design
- Database design
- Architecture setup

Sprint 3 (Week 3): Backend Development

- Spring Boot setup
- Authentication system
- API development

Sprint 4 (Week 4): Frontend Development

- React development
- UI integration with backend
- Core features implementation

Sprint 5 (Week 5): Testing & Delivery

- System testing
- Bug fixing
- Documentation
- Final presentation

RESOURCE REQUIREMENTS

- Two student laptops
- Internet access
- Visual Studio Code
- React.js
- Spring Boot
- PostgreSQL
- Postman
- GitHub repository
- Project supervisor

BUDGET

- Internet bundles: 10,000 TZS
- Printing and documentation: 5,000 TZS
- Communication: 5,000 TZS

Total Budget: 20,000 TZS

ANTICIPATED OUTPUT

The expected output is a working web-based prototype called **University Innovation Connect (UIC)**.

The system will include:

- User authentication system
- Idea posting module
- Comment and feedback system
- Voting system
- Lecturer feedback functionality

CONCLUSION

University Innovation Connect (UIC) is a web-based system designed to improve collaboration between students and lecturers at SUZA by providing a structured platform for sharing and improving innovative ideas.

The system will enhance communication, reduce loss of ideas, and promote innovation within the university environment. By applying the Agile methodology, the system will be developed incrementally, ensuring flexibility, continuous improvement, and successful delivery within the project timeline.